



Deep Dive Session

AI-Assisted Benefits Explainer

Guided answers. Clear next steps. Real member impact.

Challenge Recap: AI- Assisted Benefits Explainer

Members ask simple, high-intent questions every day.

"Am I covered?" | "Where do I go?" | "What do I do next?"

Core challenge: Build a guided, AI-assisted experience that interprets a member question, returns a structured answer, and drives to a clear next step.

Not generic chat. A guided experience.



Where members are struggling most

2 out of 3 member calls today:

ID card | Benefits and Eligibility | Finding a Doctor

Rank	Top self-service topic	Estimated frequency
1	ID cards and member ID	25 to 35%
2	Benefits and eligibility	20 to 30%
3	Find an in-network doctor	15 to 20%
4	Claims and claim history	10 to 15%
5	Reimbursement and out-of-network	5 to 10%

Sources: vsp.com member survey (1,330 respondents), contact center data, VOC feedback.

Classification: Confidential



What's in, what's out

In Scope

- Logged-in members
- The top self-service topics
- Web/mobile app experiences
- Guided, structured answers with a clear next step
- Billing questions for individual plan members
- Educational questions about VSP (e.g. How do I create an account)

Out of Scope

- Executing account creation, login, or password flows
- Live production data (mock all data)
- General customer service unrelated to member self-service



Guided experience, not generic chat

Member asks: *"Am I due for new glasses?"*

A generic chatbot:

- Answers with generic vision insurance information
- Miss that they might have contacts instead of glasses
- Return the same answer to every member regardless of plan
- Not know when to ask for more context
- Hand back a wall of policy language

A guided AI experience:

- Recognize which member is asking (self or dependent)
- Check plan-specific eligibility and timing
- Consider glasses vs. contacts
- Return a plan-appropriate answer with required disclaimers
- Guide to a next step, like find a doctor or see my full benefits



What to build for

Must show

Grounded responses

Anchor answers in structured content like plan documents, coverage data and member profile (RAG), not free-form generation.

Personalized to the member

Different plans, different answers. The pattern reflects this member's situation.

Clear escalation

Know when to hand off to a human: off-topic, low confidence, appeals, member requests.

Handle gracefully

Consistency

Same question, same answer, even if asked differently.

Session integrity

Do not re-ask for info the member already gave. When compliance requires re-verification, explain why.

Out-of-scope questions

Redirect once, but do not loop. If off-topic persists, escalate.

Confidence-aware

When unsure, ask a clarifying question or escalate. Do not guess.

Design for the human

Tone-adaptive

Warm, plainspoken, quietly confident. Empathetic when the member is frustrated or the topic is sensitive.

Compliance-aware

Respect HIPAA, PII, and plan-specific rules. Handle authentication before sharing PHI.

Content-agnostic architecture

Build so content can be swapped and expanded over time.



Resources to help you build

We can share

- Example member questions and phrasing
- Example structured response formats
- Top member intents from real data
- Tone and language guidance
- Escalation flow examples
- Business context: benefits terminology, member journey

You will need to mock

- Member profiles (*commercial or individual plan, etc.*)
- Benefits and coverage data
- Provider directory
- Statement and claims history
- Any system connections

We cannot share

- Production data
- Real member information
- Live vsp.com or app system access



Demo success: 3 minutes

- **A working prototype:** Demonstrate the pattern – interpret, structured answer, next step.
- **Quality over quantity:** 5 to 10 questions handled well, not 50 handled shallowly.
- **Consistency shown live:** Ask the same question 2 or 3 different ways, get the same answer.
- **Edge cases:** Escalation, low confidence, or out-of-scope handled cleanly.
- **A demo story:** Walk us through a real member moment.
- **Scale-ready thinking:** How could this extend across web, app, or related VSP experiences over time?



Stay in touch

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Anticipated Questions

What data will we have access to?	No production data. You'll mock member profiles, benefits, provider directory, and claims. We'll share example utterances and top intents.
Can we use any AI model or framework?	Use approved technologies per Hackathon rules. Pick what your team knows or wants to explore. Ideally it would be scalable for our real-life use cases.
Does it have to be text? Could it be voice or hybrid?	Not text-only but preferred foundation. If you want to explore voice or a mix, we're open. What matters is the pattern: interpret, structured answer, clear next step.
Where should this live — app, web, or both?	Both are in scope. Whichever context you build in, aim for a pattern that can scale across both.
How much do we build vs. mock?	Build the interaction pattern for real. Mock everything else.
How do we know if we're on the right track?	Feel free to check in via Teams if you want to run anything by us.

